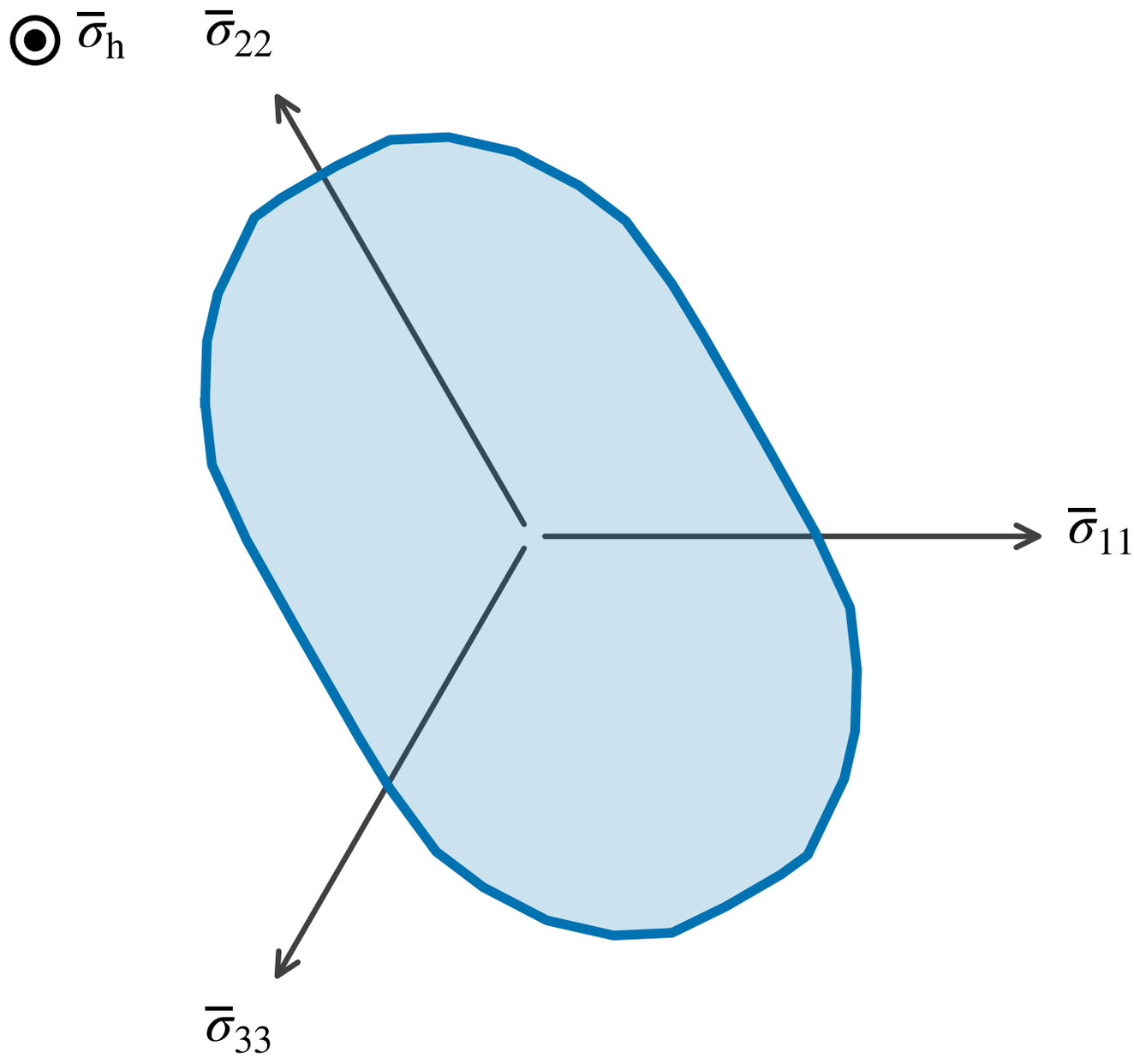Initial surface viewed along the hydrostatic axis